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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

SUNDAY, 11 OCTOBER 2026

17 must-know stories, 23 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 500 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Andhra Pradesh govt. accepts Dedicated Commission's recommendations on BC reservation

The Andhra Pradesh government issued orders accepting the Rajiv Ranjan Mishra Commission recommendations for Backward Class reservations in rural and urban local bodies. The decision follows the Andhra Pradesh High Court October 1 judgment and the Supreme Court October 9 pronouncement regarding local body polls. Combined reservations for BCs, Scheduled Castes, and Scheduled Tribes must not exceed the 50 per cent ceiling in any local body. The government constituted the dedicated commission through GO Ms No 3 on February 19, 2026, to fulfill Supreme Court triple-test requirements. The commission conducted an empirical inquiry using the Unified Family Survey, SGSW Department data, NFHS reports, and Census data. Reservations for SCs and STs continue to comply with Articles 243D and 243T of the Constitution based on population figures. Since BC Census population data are unavailable, the government accepted empirical data from the Unified Family Survey and SGSW records. The Panchayat Raj and Rural Development and Municipal Administration departments received directions to implement the recommendations accordingly. The government noted that adequate BC representation in local bodies is essential for strengthening grassroots democracy and social justice.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** Andhra Pradesh · **Who:** Rajiv Ranjan Mishra Commission, Andhra Pradesh Government, Supreme Court · **Prelims:** Rajiv Ranjan Mishra headed the Dedicated Commission on BC reservations in Andhra Pradesh.; GO Ms No 17 was issued by the Backward Classes Welfare Department on October 10, 2026.; The combined reservations for BCs, SCs, and STs must not exceed 50 per cent in any local body.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Ensures compliance with judicial directives on local body reservations and the 50 percent ceiling rule.; Provides an empirical baseline for BC political representation in the absence of a recent caste census.*

Static — Articles 243D and 243T of the Constitution mandate reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in Panchayats and Municipalities proportionate to their population. The Supreme Court in the Vikas Kishanrao Gawali v. State of Maharashtra case laid down the triple-test requirement for providing reservation to backward classes in local body elections. The triple test requires setting up a dedicated commission to conduct empirical inquiry into the nature of backwardness, specifying proportion of reservation, and ensuring total reservations do not exceed 50 percent.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Judgment

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on thehansindia.com · also reported by The Times of India

GS2 MAKE NOTES

The federal dilemma of delimitation

The issue gained attention during the introduction of the Bill to increase Lok Sabha seats. The Centre's oral assurance regarding a pro-rata increase in Lok Sabha seats has sparked debate over federal implications and parliamentary efficiency. The Centre made an oral assurance while introducing the Bill to increase Lok Sabha seats that each State's share would increase by 50% on a pro-rata basis. However, the increase could weaken the Rajya Sabha's role as a check on the Lower House, while the Lok Sabha's limited sitting days would leave MPs with less time to raise issues

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** India · **Who:** The Centre · **Prelims:** The Centre made an oral assurance while introducing the Bill to increase Lok Sabha seats.; Each State's share was assured to increase by 50% on a pro-rata basis.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It directly impacts the federal power balance between northern and southern States in India.; It touches upon the constitutional checks and balances between the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha.*

Static — Delimitation is the act of redrawing boundaries of Lok Sabha and State Assembly constituencies to represent changing population figures. Under Article 82 of the Constitution, Parliament enacts a Delimitation Act after every Census. The 84th Amendment of 2001 froze the total number of seats in Parliament based on the 1971 census until the first census after 2026.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

The Hindu: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Privacy of citizens being compromised, says Kerala HC; directs Centre to make Data Protection Board functional in eight weeks

The Kerala High Court issued this directive while emphasizing the delay in operationalizing the board constituted under the DPDPA, 2023. The Kerala High Court has directed the Central government to make the Data Protection Board functional within eight weeks, noting that citizens' privacy is being compromised. The board is constituted under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** Kerala · **Who:** Kerala High Court, Central Government · **Prelims:** The Data Protection Board is constituted under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.; The Kerala High Court directed the Centre to make the board functional in eight weeks.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights judicial intervention in enforcing statutory deadlines for administrative bodies.; Reinforces the protection of citizen privacy as a matter of urgent constitutional importance.*

Static — The Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDPA), 2023 governs the processing of digital personal data in India. The Data Protection Board of India is established by the Central Government under the DPDPA, 2023 as an adjudicatory body. The board is empowered to determine non-compliance with the provisions of the Act and impose penalties.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

The Hindu: read the source · also reported by The Times of India, Hindustan Times, Times of India, All India Radio (NewsOnAir), Scroll

GS2 MAKE NOTES

2025 ruling ‘last nail in coffin’ of 1987 order on delay condonation: SC

The Supreme Court criticized its 1987 ruling in Collector, Land Acquisition, Anantnag Vs Mst Katiji, stating it had become a panacea for condoning delays. A bench of justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu remarked that a 2025 judgment authored by Justice JB Pardiwala serves as the last nail in the coffin of the 1987 order. The core issue is that an overly liberal approach to limitation periods has allowed litigation to continue indefinitely despite inordinate delays and bureaucratic indifference. The bench made these observations while dismissing appeals by Karvy Stock Broking Limited and its former chairman C Parthasarathy against orders of the Securities Appellate Tribunal. SAT had refused to condone delays in challenging penalties imposed by the Securities and Exchange Board of India. The 2025 Shivamma case judgment held that a litigant seeking condonation must explain the entire period from the commencement of limitation until actual filing. The court also refused to extend special indulgence to government bodies or public instrumentalities for procedural red tape or bureaucratic delays. The bench emphasized that the strict limitation standards will apply equally to both private litigants and regulatory bodies like SEBI.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Justice Dipankar Datta, Justice Sheel Nagu, Justice JB Pardiwala, Karvy Stock Broking Limited, SEBI, Securities Appellate Tribunal · **Prelims:** The 1987 ruling criticized by the Supreme Court is Collector, Land Acquisition, Anantnag Vs Mst Katiji.; The 2025 judgment referred to as the last nail in the coffin was authored by Justice JB Pardiwala in the Shivamma case.; The case involved appeals by Karvy Stock Broking Limited and C Parthasarathy against the Securities Appellate Tribunal.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It curtails the misuse of condonation of delay applications by litigants seeking to revive stale claims.; It holds government bodies and regulators like SEBI to the same strict deadlines as private citizens, curbing bureaucratic delays.*

Static — The law of limitation prescribes the time-frame within which different types of legal suits, appeals, or applications must be filed in courts. Section 5 of the Limitation Act, 1963, allows courts to admit appeals or applications after the prescribed period if the appellant satisfies the court of sufficient cause for not preferring it within time. The concept of sufficient cause is not strictly defined in the statute, leaving its interpretation to judicial discretion based on the facts and circumstances of each case.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Hindustan Times: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Normal metro services, free movement, undisturbed internet: Supreme Court's 5 big directives on Delhi curbs amid protest

The Supreme Court held a special Sunday hearing regarding widespread administrative and security curbs imposed across Delhi. The directives followed massive curbs and the detention of around 7,000 people amid calls to protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. At issue was balancing the maintenance of public order with citizens' fundamental rights to free movement, peaceful assembly, and communication. The Supreme Court ordered that metro and rail services must function normally unless specific regulations are necessary to prevent public disorder. The bench mandated that internet facilities across the national capital must remain completely undisturbed. Authorities were directed to permit the free and smooth movement of citizens subject to regular traffic regulations. The court ordered an immediate review of police barricades in Delhi considering traffic conditions and prevailing law and order. The bench ruled against unlawful detentions, stating detentions must strictly follow procedures established by law. The order specifically protected peaceful and unarmed gatherings outside areas where Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita applies.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court of India, Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, Delhi Police · **Prelims:** Supreme Court directives mandated undisturbed internet access and normal operations of metro and rail services in Delhi.

Why it matters — *Reinforces the proportionality doctrine regarding state restrictions on civil liberties and public mobility during mass protests.; Affirms judicial scrutiny over widespread internet shutdowns and blanket preventive detentions.*

Static — Article 19(1)(a), (b), and (d) guarantees freedoms of speech, peaceful assembly without arms, and movement throughout India, subject to reasonable restrictions under Articles 19(2) and 19(3). Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), replacing Section 144 CrPC, empowers magistrates to issue prohibitory orders to prevent obstruction, nuisance, or danger to human life. In Anuradha Bhasin v. Union of India (2020), the Supreme Court ruled that freedom of speech and trade via the internet is protected under Article 19(1).

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Hindustan Times: read the source · also reported by The Law Observer

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Reforming India’s Tribunal System

The topic is in the news due to ongoing discussions and judicial oversight regarding tribunal vacancies and governance. The government is reviewing and considering structural reforms for India's tribunal system to address administrative challenges and ensure speedy justice.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Government of India

Why it matters — *Crucial for reducing the burden on conventional courts by providing domain-specific expertise.; Ensures timely resolution of complex technical, commercial, and administrative disputes.*

Static — Tribunals in India derive their constitutional basis from Articles 323A and 323B, which were added by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1976. Article 323A deals exclusively with administrative tribunals for public service matters, while Article 323B provides for tribunals on other matters like taxation and industrial disputes. Parliament or State Legislatures can establish these tribunals by law to adjudicate disputes outside the normal hierarchical court system.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution

PIB: read the source

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India is honored to host the First BIMSTEC Home Ministers’ Meeting in New Delhi, says Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Shri Amit Shah

Bangladesh decided to send Home Ministry Senior Secretary Manzur Morshed Chowdhury to the first BIMSTEC home ministers' meeting in New Delhi instead of Home Minister Salahuddin Ahmed. The decision to send a senior secretary rather than the cabinet minister marks a notable diplomatic choice by Bangladesh for the inaugural regional security gathering. The core issue centers on enhancing regional security cooperation, intelligence sharing, and combating transnational crime and terrorism across member states. The inaugural meeting of BIMSTEC home ministers takes place in New Delhi on Tuesday, bringing together representatives from seven member states. Member states participating include Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand. Senior officials expected to attend include Bhutan's home minister, Myanmar's union minister for home affairs, and Nepal's home minister. The meeting follows a mandate from the 4th BIMSTEC Summit held in Kathmandu on August 30-31, 2018. The gathering aims to review and expand regional security cooperation under the framework established by regional leaders. The ministerial meeting is supported by a preceding senior officials' meeting of home and interior ministries.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Manzur Morshed Chowdhury, Salahuddin Ahmed · **Prelims:** Manzur Morshed Chowdhury is the Home Ministry Senior Secretary of Bangladesh.; Salahuddin Ahmed is the Home Minister of Bangladesh.; The 4th BIMSTEC Summit was held in Kathmandu on August 30-31, 2018.

Why it matters — *Highlights diplomatic representation norms and bilateral engagements within regional groupings.; Reflects regional efforts to boost intelligence sharing and counter transnational crime in the Bay of Bengal.*

Static — BIMSTEC is an international organisation comprising seven countries of the Bay of Bengal region: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand. It was established on June 6, 1997, through the Bangkok Declaration, originally formed as BIST-EC involving Bangladesh, India, Sri Lanka, and Thailand before expanding. The grouping bridges South Asia and Southeast Asia, focusing on technical and economic cooperation across multiple sectors like trade, technology, and security.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Internal Security · Prelims angle: Award

Hindustan Times: read the source · free copy on thedailystar.net

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, Israel Sign 16 MoUs; PM Modi and PM Netanyahu Announce Special Strategic Partnership

India and Israel signed 16 memoranda of understanding during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's two-day state visit to Israel, elevating bilateral ties to a Special Strategic Partnership. The agreements span artificial intelligence, agriculture, cybersecurity, fintech, labour mobility, education, fisheries, and cultural exchanges. A key agreement was signed between NPCI International and Israel's MASAV to enable cross-border remittances using India's Unified Payments Interface. The India-Israel Innovation Centre for Agriculture was established under ICAR and MASHAV to focus on precision farming, satellite-based irrigation, and advanced agricultural technologies. Three implementation protocols on labour mobility were signed to enable regulated recruitment of up to 50,000 Indian workers over the next five years across commerce, manufacturing, and restaurant sectors. Other pacts include cooperation in geophysical exploration using AI, development of the National Maritime Heritage Complex at Lothal, and a Cultural Exchange Programme for 2026-2029. A letter of intent was issued to establish an Indo-Israel Cyber Centre of Excellence in India for cybersecurity and digital resilience. The two nations also elevated their Joint Committee on Science and Technology to a ministerial level and launched a new initiative on critical and emerging technologies.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** Israel · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu · **Prelims:** India and Israel inked 16 memoranda of understanding during the visit.; NPCI International and Israel's MASAV signed an MoU for cross-border remittances using UPI.; The quota for Indian workers established under the pact is up to 50,000 over the next five years.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands India's digital public infrastructure footprint globally through the integration of UPI with Israel's MASAV for cross-border remittances.; Provides structured, regulated employment avenues for up to 50,000 Indian workers in Israel over the next five years.*

Static — India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in January 1992, which since expanded into a robust partnership spanning defense, agriculture, science, and technology. Unified Payments Interface is an instant real-time payment system developed by the National Payments Corporation of India, facilitating inter-bank peer-to-peer and merchant transactions. The Indian Council of Agricultural Research is an apex body for coordinating agricultural research and education in India, operating under the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Visit of EAM to Ghana, Côte d’Ivoire and Ethiopia (October 06–10, 2026)

External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar paid an official visit to Ghana, Côte d’Ivoire and Ethiopia from October 6 to 10, 2026. The visit aimed to strengthen India's bilateral partnerships in trade, investment, defence, technology, healthcare and capacity building. In Ghana, Jaishankar met President John Dramani Mahama and Foreign Minister Samuel Okudzeto Ablakwa to review bilateral cooperation and global issues. Ghana handed over its Instrument of Acceptance for the International Big Cat Alliance during the EAM's visit. Ghana and India signed two memoranda of understanding covering academic, scientific, agricultural research and capacity-building cooperation. In Côte d’Ivoire, Jaishankar met President Alassane Ouattara, Vice-Prime Minister Téné Birahima Ouattara, and Foreign Minister Nialé Kaba. Both sides noted bilateral trade exceeds US$1.5 billion and discussed expanding economic ties through local manufacturing and value addition. In Ethiopia, Jaishankar called on Prime Minister Dr. Abiy Ahmed Ali and held talks with Foreign Minister Dr. Gedion Timothewos on digital public infrastructure, AI and defence.

When: October 06–10, 2026 · **Where:** Ghana, Côte d’Ivoire, Ethiopia · **Who:** S. Jaishankar, John Dramani Mahama, Alassane Ouattara, Abiy Ahmed Ali · **Prelims:** Bilateral trade between India and Côte d’Ivoire exceeds US$1.5 billion.; Ghana handed over its Instrument of Acceptance for the International Big Cat Alliance.; Ghana and India signed two MoUs on agricultural research, education, academic, scientific research and capacity-building.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces India's commitment to championing the priorities of the Global South and African nations in international platforms.; Expands economic partnerships, defence cooperation, and supply chain resilience in pharmaceuticals, critical minerals, and agriculture with African economies.*

Static — India's diplomatic outreach to Africa is guided by the foundational principles of South-South cooperation, mutual respect, and developmental partnership without conditionalities. The Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) is a regional political and economic union of fifteen countries located in West Africa. The African Union, which became a permanent member of the G20 under India's G20 presidency, represents 55 member states across the continent.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

thestatesman.com: read the source · also reported by News On AIR, Agenzia Nova

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, Japan seal 16 key outcomes across AI, economic security, energy and mobility

India and Japan announced 16 major outcomes following the 16th India-Japan Annual Summit. The agreements aim to expand cooperation in artificial intelligence, economic security, clean energy, and critical minerals. Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi led the bilateral talks. A Joint Declaration on Economic Security focuses on semiconductors, ICT, AI, and pharmaceuticals. A Joint Statement on AI establishes a strategic R&D partnership covering the entire AI technology stack. A Joint Statement on Energy Resilience targets cooperation in strategic crude reserves and maritime energy transport. The India-Japan Cooperative Biogas Initiative aims to set up 1,000 biogas plants across India. Both nations agreed to celebrate 2027 as the India-Japan Year of Shared Horizons for 75 years of diplomatic ties.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** India and Japan · **Who:** Narendra Modi and Sanae Takaichi · **Prelims:** The 16th India-Japan Annual Summit resulted in 16 key outcomes.; The year 2027 will be celebrated as the India-Japan Year of Shared Horizons.; The Cooperative Biogas for Growth Initiative aims to establish 1,000 biogas and organic fertilizer plants in India.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens resilient supply chains for critical minerals, semiconductors, and active pharmaceutical ingredients.; Elevates bilateral technological cooperation through joint artificial intelligence research and development.*

Static — India and Japan established diplomatic relations in 1952, laying the foundation for long-term economic and cultural ties. The India-Japan Annual Summit is the apex institutional dialogue mechanism between the prime ministers of both countries. Bilateral security and economic cooperation have deepened significantly under the Indo-Pacific framework and the Quad grouping.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Science & Technology, Economy

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India unveils steel policy aiming for 604 million tonne capacity by 2047

The central government has released the draft National Steel Policy 2047 to guide long-term capacity expansion and decarbonisation. A revision of the 2017 policy became necessary due to expanding domestic capacity, rising global standing, and the emergence of Industry 4.0 technologies. The core challenge involves balancing rapid industrial growth with high import dependence on coking coal and significant carbon emission intensity. Under the policy, crude steel capacity is targeted to reach 604 million tonnes and finished steel demand to hit 505 million tonnes by 2047. Per capita steel consumption is projected to rise to 302 kg from the current level of 116 kg, with exports targeted at 45 million tonnes. To address the 92 per cent import dependence on coking coal, the draft outlines washery expansion, domestic mining, overseas asset acquisition, and AI blending. The secondary steel sector, comprising 2,550 units and 47 per cent of production capacity, will receive dedicated raw material and technology support. Decarbonisation measures aim to reduce the sector emission intensity of 2.54 tonnes of CO2 per tonne of steel towards the 2070 Net Zero goal.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** New Delhi, India · **Who:** Ministry of Steel and Steel Secretary Sandeep Poundrik · **Prelims:** India imports approximately 92 per cent of its coking coal requirement.; The secondary steel sector accounts for around 47 per cent of India's crude steel capacity.; Indian steelmaking emits 2.54 tonnes of CO2 per tonne of crude steel, above the global average of 1.92 tonnes.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Supports national infrastructure and manufacturing expansion by projecting per capita steel consumption to rise to 302 kg by 2047.; Promotes industrial green transition through scrap utilisation, green hydrogen adoption, and renewable energy integration to meet climate commitments.*

Static — The steel industry in India was completely deregulated in 1991-92, removing pricing and distribution controls and permitting 100 percent foreign direct investment under the automatic route. The Ministry of Steel formulates policies, coordinates raw material allocation, and oversees public sector enterprises including the Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL) and NMDC. Blast Furnace-Basic Oxygen Furnace (BF-BOF) and Electric Arc Furnace/Induction Furnace (EAF/IF) are the two primary routes of commercial crude steelmaking in India.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, Environment & Ecology

BusinessLine: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com · also reported by Business Standard

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI tightens rules for forex bets to shield bruised rupee

The Reserve Bank of India announced stricter regulations for foreign exchange derivatives on October 10 to maintain orderly market functioning and shield the rupee. The rules were introduced amid changing market conditions and a shrinking of India's forex reserves by $13 billion to $734.6 billion in four consecutive weekly declines. Authorised dealers are now restricted from permitting customers to rebook rupee-linked foreign exchange derivative contracts cancelled after the issuance of directions. The threshold for undertaking foreign exchange derivative transactions without establishing underlying exposure was slashed from $100 million to $5 million. Permissible limits for exchange-traded currency derivatives involving the rupee without underlying exposure were also lowered to $5 million across all stock exchanges combined. Authorised dealers must obtain customer undertakings confirming that underlying exposures have not been hedged elsewhere to prevent multiple hedging. A new Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve requires dealers to keep a cash reserve with the RBI equal to 20% of the notional amount for transactions exceeding $2 million. Banks must now maintain at least 99% of their prescribed daily Cash Reserve Ratio from October 16, up from 90% previously, reducing liquidity management flexibility.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** India's forex reserves shrank by $13 billion to $734.6 billion in the fourth straight weekly decline.; The threshold for derivative transactions without underlying exposure was lowered from $100 million to $5 million.; A new Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve requires a 20% cash reserve for specified transactions exceeding $2 million.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Aims to curb speculative pressure on the Indian rupee and maintain stability in the foreign exchange market.; Reduces liquidity management flexibility for commercial banks by enforcing a strict 99% daily CRR maintenance rule.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The Cash Reserve Ratio is the minimum percentage of a bank's total deposits that must be maintained in cash with the RBI. Foreign exchange derivatives are financial contracts whose value depends on an underlying foreign exchange asset, rate, or index, used for hedging or speculation.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on freepressjournal.in · also reported by PSU India, www.usthadian.com, Business Standard

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Quarter of India’s labour force highly exposed to AI, says report

The release of the report assessing artificial intelligence exposure levels across India's workforce. A report reveals that one-fourth of India's labour force is highly exposed to artificial intelligence, impacting job profiles through either substitution or complementary productivity gains. The higher exposure to AI can have both complementary and substitution effects depending on the job profile with 7.6% of the workforce expected to see increased productivity

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** India · **Who:** BusinessLine Economy · **Prelims:** Quarter of India's labour force is highly exposed to AI.; 7.6% of the workforce is expected to see increased productivity.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the urgent need for comprehensive workforce upskilling and reskilling policies in India.; Helps policymakers understand the dual impact of automation on employment substitution versus productivity enhancement.*

Static — Artificial intelligence encompasses technologies that enable machines to mimic human intelligence, including machine learning and natural language processing. Labour market exposure to AI is typically measured by analyzing task overlap between automation capabilities and daily job requirements. Skill development and reskilling initiatives are crucial policy tools for mitigating technological unemployment and bridging the digital divide.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Report/Index

BusinessLine: read the source

Agriculture & Allied

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India’s Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses

India's total pulse production rose to 274.09 lakh tonnes in 2025-26 from 256.83 lakh tonnes in 2024-25, driven by the 'Mission for Aatmanirbharta'. The scheme was launched on October 11 last year with an outlay of Rs 11,440 crore to achieve self-sufficiency in pulses production by 2030-31. The core issue is reducing heavy import dependence while boosting domestic output and nutritional security through assured procurement and better seeds. Pulse imports declined by 31.52 per cent from Rs 46,427.60 crore in 2024-25 to Rs 31,793.59 crore in 2025-26. Exports grew by 13.4 per cent to reach $969.53 million and a volume of 10.01 lakh tonnes in 2025-26. Pulse cultivation area expanded from 277.20 lakh hectares to 286.46 lakh hectares, while yield improved from 926 kg to 957 kg per hectare. Strategic measures include a cluster-based approach across 489 districts focusing on tur, urad, and masoor, alongside free seed kit distribution. Assured procurement at MSP for tur, urad, and masoor is being handled by the NCCF and the NAFED from registered farmers. By 2030-31, production is targeted to reach nearly 350 lakh tonnes with a yield of 1,130 kg per hectare.

When: October 11, 2025 · **Where:** India · **Who:** NCCF and NAFED · **Prelims:** Pulse production reached 274.09 lakh tonnes in 2025-26.; Total pulse cultivation area in 2025-26 was 286.46 lakh hectares.; The financial outlay for the Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses is Rs 11,440 crore.

Why it matters — *Helps conserve foreign exchange by drastically reducing expensive pulse imports.; Improves farm incomes and rural livelihoods in major cultivating states.*

Static — India is the world's largest producer and consumer of pulses, making domestic self-sufficiency vital for national food and nutritional security. Pulses are rich in protein containing 20-25 percent, which is double that of wheat and triple that of rice, and they also naturally fix atmospheric nitrogen to enrich soil health. Minimum Support Price (MSP) acts as a government safety net to protect farmers from drastic price drops and ensure remunerative returns for key crops.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

PIB: read the source · free copy on morungexpress.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India moves toward ‘UPI moment’ for agriculture through digital public infrastructure

The initiative is in the news as the country actively moves toward implementing digital public infrastructure for agriculture. India is developing a digital public infrastructure for the agriculture sector to create a UPI-like transformational impact.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Government of India · **Prelims:** The initiative focuses on digital public infrastructure for agriculture.; It draws parallels to the UPI model of digital transformation.

Why it matters — *It has the potential to revolutionize agricultural credit, subsidies, and advisory services akin to how UPI transformed digital payments.; It addresses structural inefficiencies in the rural economy by formalizing land and farmer data.*

Static — Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) refers to foundational digital systems such as identity, payment, and data exchange that help public and private service delivery. AgriStack is a digital public infrastructure for agriculture being built by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare in India. It creates a unified farmers' service platform by seeding land records with digital identities.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied, Economy, Infrastructure & Energy

AgroSpectrum India: read the source

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India, France partner on TRISHNA satellite launching within 12-16 months

The announcement of the upcoming launch timeline for the joint Indo-French TRISHNA satellite project. India and France are partnering on the TRISHNA satellite mission, which is scheduled for launch within 12 to 16 months.

When: Within 12-16 months · **Where:** India and France · **Who:** ISRO and CNES · **Prelims:** The TRISHNA satellite is a joint partnership between India and France.; The satellite is scheduled to launch within 12 to 16 months.

Why it matters — *Enhances bilateral cooperation in advanced space technology and earth observation between India and France.; Provides critical data for managing water resources and improving agricultural planning in changing climatic conditions.*

Static — ISRO is India's national space agency, established in 1969 and headquartered in Bengaluru under the Department of Space. CNES is the French government space agency responsible for shaping France's space policy in Europe. India and France have a long-standing history of space cooperation dating back to the early days of the Indian space programme.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, International Relations

NewsBytes: read the source · also reported by The Hindu

Internal Security

GS3 MAKE NOTES

9 killed as Naga-Kuki clashes flare across 3 Manipur districts within 24 hrs

At least nine people were killed across three districts of Manipur in 24 hours amid renewed Naga-Kuki clashes. The violence was triggered by the killing of a 42-year-old Kuki woman in cross-fire during a security forces drive against illegal bunkers in Kamjong. The core issue involves escalating ethnic tensions and armed confrontations between the Naga and Kuki communities across multiple districts. Kamjong and Kangpokpi districts recorded four deaths each, while one person of Nepalese origin was killed in an ambush in Ukhrul. Security forces including state police, IRB, and BSF were involved in operations to destroy illegal bunkers near Chassad police station. Civil society groups like the Kuki Women Union and the Committee on Tribal Unity (CoTU) responded with statements and shutdowns. Manipur Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh met Prime Minister Narendra Modi in Delhi and instructed authorities to restore peace and order. Police and security experts have cautioned that the latest casualties could further escalate ethnic tensions and violence in the state.

When: 2026-10-11 · **Where:** Manipur · **Who:** Y Khemchand Singh, Narendra Modi, Domkhonei Touthang · **Prelims:** At least nine people were killed across Kamjong, Kangpokpi, and Ukhrul districts.; Kamjong and Kangpokpi recorded four deaths each, and Ukhrul recorded one death.; The initial clash occurred near Chassad police station in Kamjong district.

Why it matters — *Highlights the persistent security challenges and breakdown of social harmony in the northeastern state.; Demonstrates how localized security operations can accidentally trigger wider inter-community retaliations.*

Static — Manipur has faced severe ethnic strife and breakdown of law and order since May 2023, resulting in hundreds of deaths and massive displacement. The state's demographic landscape features distinct geographic enclaves inhabited by Meitei, Kuki, and Naga communities. Central security forces such as the Assam Rifles, BSF, and Indian Reserve Battalions are deployed extensively to maintain order in sensitive areas.

Syllabus: GS3: Internal Security
Hindustan Times: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

Haryana cabinet gives nod to amendments to Agniveer policy for gainful employment

The Haryana cabinet gave its nod to these amendments to facilitate gainful employment for ex-Agniveers, as announced by Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini. The Haryana cabinet approved amendments to its Agniveer policy to exempt ex-Agniveers from all examinations prescribed for direct recruitment to Group-C posts.
The Hindu: source

DEFENCE | EXERCISE | QUICK READ

INS TRISHUL ARRIVES AT PLYMOUTH, UK FOR EXERCISE KONKAN 2026

Indian Navy stealth frigate INS Trishul arrived at Plymouth to participate in the bilateral maritime Exercise KONKAN-26. The exercise is being conducted to enhance interoperability and mutual operational coordination between the two partner navies. The engagement tests both navies' capacity to coordinate across complex maritime warfare scenarios and promotes open seas. Exercise KONKAN has been held for over two decades, growing significantly in operational scale and tactical complexity.
PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Delhi To Launch 1,300 Pink Electric Autos With Women, Transgender Drivers

The Delhi government is launching the DURGA E-Auto Scheme to allot 1,300 pink electric autos in its first phase. Out of the total vehicles, 1,170 are reserved for women and 130 are designated for transgender persons. The cabinet under Chief Minister Rekha Gupta approved the scheme to provide steady livelihoods and promote electric transport.
NDTV: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Opium Act Conviction Upheld: Supreme Court Clarifies Trial Procedures

The Supreme Court delivered a verdict clarifying trial procedures in an Opium Act conviction case. The Supreme Court upheld a conviction under the Opium Act while clarifying important legal and trial procedures.
The Law Observer: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | APPOINTMENT | QUICK READ

New Deputy Election Commissioner appointed in ECI amid concerns over work hierarchy

Rajasthan-cadre IAS officer Prakash Rajpurohit has been appointed as Deputy Election Commissioner in the Election Commission of India. He fills the vacancy created by Sanjay Kumar, who was prematurely repatriated to his parent AGMUT cadre in August 2026. The appointment comes amid internal concerns raised by Election Commissioners SS Sandhu and Vivek Joshi over the routing of files from the IT department.
The Hindu: source

EDUCATION | APPOINTMENT | QUICK READ

UGC Chairman Dr Mamun appointed Chairman of Board of Governors of South Asian University in New Delhi

The official announcement of Dr Mamun taking over the leadership role at the university put it in the news. UGC Chairman Dr Mamun has been appointed as the Chairman of the Board of Governors of South Asian University in New Delhi.
The Country Today: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Land Acquisition Notification Invalid Without Specifying Locality: Supreme Court Clarifies

The Supreme Court issued this clarification regarding the legal validity of land acquisition notifications. The Supreme Court clarified that any land acquisition notification issued without specifying the exact locality is legally invalid.
The Law Observer: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Census 2027: Mizoram to enumerate refugees separately

The announcement comes in light of the state hosting tens of thousands of displaced persons and refugees amidst differing official and local estimates. Mizoram is preparing to enumerate refugees from Bangladesh, Myanmar, and Manipur separately during the Census 2027. Mizoram has more than 38,000 refugees from Bangladesh, Myanmar and Manipur, but local organisations put the figure at over 60,000

The Hindu: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Life-Saving Irrigation Scheme launched to protect orchards in Sri Sathya Sai district

Farmers faced dried-up borewells, prompting the government to intervene and cover 80% of the water cost. The government launched a Life-Saving Irrigation Scheme in the Sri Sathya Sai district to supply water via tankers for distressed orchards. Government will bear 80% of water cost for farmers with dried-up borewells, says official adding tanker supply to cover sweet lime, mango and arecanut crops

The Hindu: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

Ayodhya Ram temple gets FSSAI's top 'Eat Right Place of Worship' rating

The Ram temple in Ayodhya received the highest 'Ati Vishisht' rating under FSSAI's 'Eat Right Place of Worship' initiative. The certification recognizes efforts to maintain food safety and hygiene standards while preparing and distributing prasad to devotees. The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra scored 103 out of 114 points in the assessment under the BHOG programme.

Business Standard: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

Text of PM’s address during the launch of development projects in Chennai

The visit marks his first trip to Tamil Nadu since the Chief Minister Vijay-led government assumed office in the state. The core initiative of the visit was to boost urban mobility, industry, trade, and job creation across Tamil Nadu. The Prime Minister and Chief Minister Vijay traveled together on the newly constructed Poonamallee-Vadapalani Metro corridor developed at a cost of Rs 750 crore.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Palamu Tiger Reserve: Villagers Surrender 31 Guns to Protect Wildlife in Jharkhand

The voluntary surrender of 31 firearms by local villagers to protect wildlife in the Palamu Tiger Reserve put it in the news. Villagers living near the Palamu Tiger Reserve in Jharkhand voluntarily surrendered 31 guns to help protect local wildlife and curb poaching.

Jharkhand State News: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Karnataka panel to study rationalisation of tiger reserve buffer zones

The standing committee of the Karnataka State Board of Wildlife decided to set up a technical committee to review a forest department proposal. The proposal aims to rationalise the boundaries of the buffer zones across all tiger reserves in the state. Buffer zones regulate activities in areas between tiger reserves and human habitations to ensure co-existence and control commercial activities.

deccanherald.com: source

HEALTH | QUICK READ

Curtain Raiser

The centre will conduct multidisciplinary biomedical and public health research suited to high-altitude environments. The Union Minister of Health & Family Welfare, Shri Jagat Prakash Nadda, will lay the foundation stone of the ICMR Centre for High Altitude Medicine and Public Health Research (ICMR-CHAMP) at Keylong in Lahaul & Spiti district, Himachal Pradesh, on 12 October 2026.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Court Fees Act Interpretation: Supreme Court Clarifies Decree Types

The judgment was reported by The Law Observer on 2026-10-11 following a judicial clarification. The Supreme Court issued a clarification on the interpretation of decree types under the Court Fees Act.

The Law Observer: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Tuvalu Faces Rising Seas: Will COP31 Leaders Act Before It’s Too Late? | Planet Pulse | N18G

The vulnerability of low-lying island nations like Tuvalu has put the spotlight on upcoming international climate negotiations and leadership accountability. Tuvalu is confronting severe existential threats from rising sea levels, raising questions about whether global leaders at upcoming climate summits like COP31 will take sufficient action.

Firstpost: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Gujarat Govt Signs Tripartite MoU to Empower Rural Women Through Dairy Farming and Boost Their Income

The Gujarat government signed a tripartite Memorandum of Understanding in Rajkot to empower rural women milk producers and promote dairy-based livelihoods. The MoU brings together the Gujarat Livelihood Promotion Company Limited, the Cooperation Department, and the Animal Husbandry Department. The initiative aims to help rural women become financially independent dairy entrepreneurs by improving access to credit, livestock, and markets.

indianmasterminds.com: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT | QUICK READ

Flash flood sweeps away houses, bridges in Nepal's Gorkha

A sudden surge in the water level of the Budhi Gandaki River swept away several houses in Gorkha, Nepal on Sunday morning. The trigger was a suspected landslide and river block in Chumnubri Rural Municipality that eventually breached, creating a massive flood. The core issue involves flash floods carrying mud and sludge, threatening downstream settlements and prompting immediate evacuations.

Hindustan Times: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Amrit Bharat Station Scheme: 26 railway stations redeveloped in Tamil Nadu as PM Modi inaugurates 5 more

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated five newly redeveloped railway stations in Tamil Nadu through video-conferencing from Chennai. The newly inaugurated stations under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme include Palani, Paramakudi, Namakkal, Ambasamudram, and Vellore Cantonment. The Prime Minister also dedicated the 23-km Karaikal–Peralam new railway line and three road overbridges at Karamadai, Sulur, and Thudiyalur to the nation.

deccanchronicle.com: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Maharashtra govt to submit detailed memorandum for Central drought relief

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis announced that the state will submit a detailed memorandum seeking Central drought relief. Deficient rainfall during a crucial crop growth stage severely affected soybean, cotton, tur, and sugarcane cultivation in the state. Rabi sowing prospects look bleak due to water shortages, leaving farmers struggling to recover from kharif crop losses.

Hindustan Times: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Narayanpet, Nagarkurnool districts receive national recognition for farm development under the Pradhan Mantri Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana

Narayanpet and Nagarkurnool districts received national recognition for farm development under the Pradhan Mantri Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana. The Pradhan Mantri Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana completed its first year since being launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The six-year initiative was approved by the Union Cabinet in July and launched on 11th October last year to strengthen agriculture in 100 Aspirational Agricultural Districts.

The Hindu: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Ruling Party: Focus on Delimitation Bill

It appeared as a news headline in Punjab Kesari English. The ruling party announced its focus on the Delimitation Bill, according to brief news reports.

Punjab Kesari English: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Scope of Article 226/227 Review Against Arbitration Appeal Orders: Supreme Court Clarifies

The ruling was issued to resolve legal ambiguities regarding High Court intervention in commercial arbitration matters. The Supreme Court clarified the permissible scope and limitations of High Courts exercising writ jurisdiction under Articles 226 and 227 against arbitration appeal orders.

TaxCorp AI: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 GST's growth lift: How procedural reforms could act as a booster shot for the Indian economy

The GST Council approved procedural reforms intended to ease business operations and stimulate economic expansion. The editorial highlights that procedural reforms cleared by the GST Council can enhance capital efficiency and improve business competitiveness. India can expect capital to flow more efficiently and give businesses the competitiveness they need with the reforms approved by the GST Council. Here's how the changes create an enabling environment for faster GDP growth.

Mint

GS2 GS3 India Will Not Succumb to Musk's Pressure Tactics

India's dispute with Elon Musk over Starlink's entry reflects a wider conflict between technological innovation, corporate influence, and national sovereignty. Three players, namely Reliance Jio, Eutelsat OneWeb, and Starlink, received licences to establish satellite communication services, sparking a race for market leadership. On October 7, Musk accused Indian business interests of delaying Starlink's launch and criticised Mukesh Ambani on X without providing supporting evidence.

BusinessLine

GS2 L'affaire ECI—what former judges' open letter gets wrong about SIR

Two open letters from 42 former judges and 98 former civil servants expressed diametrically opposite views on the Election Commission of India and the Special Intensive Revision. The former judges expressed grave concern over a perceived campaign by vested political interests to undermine the ECI and question its integrity. The judges defended the Special Intensive Revision as a legally established exercise meant to ensure clean and accurate voter lists without evidence of vote theft.

ThePrint

GS3 Editorial. GST without chains

The GST Council recently pushed for ease of doing business reforms. The editorial examines the GST Council's push for ease of doing business reforms to unchain the indirect tax regime. GST Council pushes ease of doing business reform

BusinessLine

GS2 Rights and wrongs: on the fundamental right to peaceful assembly and protest

It is in the news due to increasing state restrictions and administrative curbs on peaceful public protests. The editorial discusses the importance of protecting the fundamental right to peaceful assembly and protest against government clampdowns on dissent. The government must not clamp down on dissent and protest

The Hindu

GS2 GS3 India-UK trade deal to boost bilateral trade by £25.5 billion annually by 2040

Britain and India signed the landmark Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement in July to deepen economic ties. The agreement is estimated to boost bilateral trade by £25.5 billion every year by 2040. Nearly £12 billion worth of trade and investment deals have already been struck since the agreement was signed. India is projected to become the third largest global economy by 2031 and house a quarter billion high-income consumers by 2050.

Economic Times

GS3 Go slow on rate hikes: Make capital accessible and affordable to drive investment and job creation

India has entered a golden age of entrepreneurship, with active companies rising from 1.6 million to 2.2 million over three years. The surge in formalisation and new businesses is driven by easing regulations and a falling cost of capital. The reduction in India's cost of capital is underpinned by the government's progress in fiscal consolidation and low general government fiscal deficits. A shrinking deficit constrains short-term growth, leaving India's output a year behind its pre-pandemic path and signaling slack in the job market.

Economic Times

GS2 SIR and a citizenship question the ECI won't answer

It appeared as an opinion piece in Deccan Herald addressing ongoing electoral roll revision controversies. An editorial discussing the reluctance of the Election Commission of India to address critical citizenship questions related to the Special Intensive Revision. SIR and a citizenship question the ECI won't answer

Deccan Herald

GS3 What is RBI seeing that markets aren't?

Recent abrupt regulatory measures by the central bank regarding foreign exchange have sparked market debate about the rupee's health. The RBI has implemented new forex trading restrictions and opened a special window for oil marketing companies, surprising market participants who expected stability given record forex reserves. These abrupt measures have confused market participants regarding the rupee's underlying strength. Many are questioning the rationale behind using crisis-era tools so soon after accumulating record forex reserves.

Economic Times

GS2 One Delhi day of 'police state'

The article was published following heavy police restrictions and the detention of an MP during protests in Delhi. An opinion piece arguing that the government's heavy-handed restrictions and police actions against protests in Delhi demonstrated a suppression of democratic dissent. GoI displayed administrative strength while revealing political weakness in handling citizen dissent. Restrictions in Delhi included turning areas into containment zones to manage protests. Police actions, including detaining Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas, demonstrated a lack of sensitivity to disagreement.

Economic Times

GS3 Can rate hikes control cost-push inflation?

The piece addresses ongoing debates among economists regarding the efficacy of monetary policy tools against supply-driven price rises. The editorial discusses the limitations of using interest rate hikes to control cost-push inflation, highlighting uncertainties around credit demand and time lags. Yes and no, because no one knows how much the rates have to increase before the demand for credit slows sufficiently and how long this process will take

BusinessLine

GS3 Can India build a truly self-reliant solar ecosystem?

India has expanded module manufacturing capacity to around 228 GW under the Approved List of Models and Manufacturers framework, up from 2.3 GW in 2014. The Rs. 24,000-crore Production Linked Incentive scheme has encouraged investment in high-efficiency and integrated solar manufacturing. A structural imbalance exists as module capacity is 6.5 times domestic cell capacity, leaving upstream stages like wafers and ingots underdeveloped. The government has expanded the ALMM framework to include upstream stages like ingots and wafers starting June 1, 2028.

Hindustan Times

GS3 Andy Mukherjee: The AI productivity boom has begun—if you know where to find it

The piece appeared as an opinion column addressing the debate over whether artificial intelligence has begun delivering measurable economic productivity. The author discusses how artificial intelligence is driving a real productivity boom that is currently visible in stock market signals rather than traditional macroeconomic data. Failure to isolate productivity gains doesn't mean that they don't exist. Stock markets are already figuring out which listed companies are gaining from the use of artificial intelligence.

Mint

GS1 GS2 India's vulnerable no longer look the way we imagine—and that has policy implications

It is an opinion piece examining how modern economic shifts challenge traditional understandings of poverty and welfare in India. The article argues that India's markers of economic insecurity have transformed, requiring a complete overhaul in how the country identifies and supports vulnerable populations. Markers of economic insecurity have transformed over time and this implies that India's development challenge is changing. How India identifies and supports the country's needy will need to change accordingly.

Mint

GS1 Migrant ethics, and life in the Maximum City

The author describes arriving in Mumbai and observing a first-time flyer eager to record his maiden flight through a scratched window. The author notes the cramped living conditions in Mumbai, where homes are often just spaces for a bed, a toilet, and shoes due to long commutes. An autorickshaw driver outside the author's hotel is observed on a WhatsApp video call with his family thousands of kilometres away.

Hindustan Times

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Explained: Why CAPF Officers Oppose IPS Deputation - Supreme Court's 2025 Verdict, 46 Postings and What Happens Next The dispute over senior command positions in India's five principal Central Armed Police Forces involves career CAPF officers versus deputed IPS officers. The immediate trigger is the Supreme Court's scrutiny of 46 IPS deputations made after its May 2025 judgment and the challenge to the 2026 Act.

indianmasterminds.com

What was the Chemistry Nobel Prize given for? The topic is in the news in connection with the themes surrounding the Chemistry Nobel Prize. This explainer details the concepts of chirality, molecular handedness, and their significance in drug development and the origins of life. What are chirality and molecular 'handedness', and why does life favour one form over the other?

The Hindu

How the Election Commission was set up, how it got 3 members in 1993 The structural evolution and composition of the Election Commission are in the news due to ongoing debates regarding judicial appointments and institutional autonomy. This explainer details the establishment of the Election Commission of India and the historical context behind its transition into a multi-member body in 1993.

Indian Express

Why UAPA demands urgent reform? The second death anniversary of acquitted Delhi University Professor G.N. Saibaba renewed calls for comprehensive reform of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act. The demand stems from concerns over prolonged pre-trial detention, vague offense definitions, and low conviction rates despite stringent procedural hurdles.

The Hindu

Behind India's Russia-Ukraine peace proposal: Grain, crude oil The proposal comes to the forefront as India navigates complex crude oil and grain dependencies alongside potential shifts in US leadership under Donald Trump. India has proposed a diplomatic peace initiative regarding the Russia-Ukraine conflict, balancing energy and food security concerns with shifting global geopolitics.
Indian Express

One Indian killed in deadliest attack in the Gulf since Iran War: What are Saudi Arabia's options? The incident occurred during a major escalation of hostilities in the Gulf, putting Saudi Arabia's strategic options in focus. An Indian national was killed in the deadliest attack in the Gulf region since the Iran War, raising security concerns.
Indian Express

Palestinian elections postponed again: What it means, what happened last time The recurring delay of polls highlights the deepening political paralysis and governance crisis in Palestinian territories. Palestinian elections have been postponed once again, extending a nearly two-decade hiatus in democratic polls for the Palestinian Authority.
Indian Express

Why are Saudi defences struggling to rebuff Houthi attacks? Recent deadly missile and drone strikes, particularly at Riyadh's airport, have exposed shortcomings in Saudi Arabia's air defence capabilities. The Houthi attacks are stretching Saudi defences and likely depleting global interceptor supplies, as the group seeks to rewrite the rules of the game.
Economic Times

Where is the time for a third language in schools? The persistent debate surrounding the implementation of language learning formulas in schools under modern educational frameworks. An analysis of the practical challenges in implementing a third language in school systems, suggesting measured and flexible pedagogical approaches.
The Hindu

Plague is the Word of the Week: Why the world fears an outbreak after 28-year-old's death in Russia The death of a 28-year-old individual from the plague in Russia put the topic in the news. A 28-year-old's death from the plague in Russia has raised global concerns about a potential disease outbreak.
Firstpost

Sick wheels: Can electric vehicles cause more motion sickness than traditional cars? The rising adoption of electric vehicles has brought increased passenger complaints regarding motion sickness caused by rapid torque and regenerative braking. This explainer examines whether electric vehicles induce higher rates of motion sickness in passengers compared to traditional vehicles due to their unique driving dynamics.
Firstpost

Dark patterns, last-minute add-on charges: How online transactions hit your wallet at checkout Mounting scrutiny over deceptive digital design choices and hidden charges led to an analysis of how online transactions affect consumer wallets. The explainer details how online platforms deploy deceptive user interfaces, termed dark patterns, and undisclosed add-on fees at final checkout to raise costs for digital consumers.
Indian Express

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Trump says Russia, Ukraine agree to 'energy ceasefire' but Kyiv says attacks continue (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- Prime Minister remembers Loknayak Jayaprakash Narayan on his birth anniversary, highlights his ideals of good governance (History, Art & Culture) PIB
- Pakistan suspends Imran Khan's party-led provincial government (International Relations) Al Jazeera
- Japan tops India's FDI chart in Q1 FY27 with $5.71 billion inflows (Economy) Business Standard
- Economic think tank says govt should withdraw proposed UPI charges. Here's why (Economy) Mint
- UPSC Ethics Simplified: What makes a good journalist? Philosophers' lessons that hold true for civil servants too (Ethics & Integrity) Indian Express
- Landslide, temporary dam breach: What may have caused fresh flash flood in Nepal (Disaster Management) Hindustan Times
- War and high debt to dominate IMF-World Bank meetings in Bangkok (Economy) Al Jazeera
- Between Opportunity And Constraint: ASEAN's Engagement With An Expanding BRICS (International Relations) Eurasia Review
- Need to look at cost of doing biz to up manufacturing: Amitabh Kant (Economy) Economic Times
- 2026 Nobel Prize, brain research, and healthcare access | Health Wrap | Episode 54 (Science & Technology) The Hindu
- CJI Surya Kant declines Opposition leaders' request for meet over SIR, CEC Gyanesh Kumar; cites judicial propriety (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- India expanding trade footprint to strengthen global ties and empower MSMEs: Piyush Goyal (Economy) Economic Times
- EU climate chief pledges greater youth role ahead of COP31 talks (Environment & Ecology) The Climate Watch
- Allahabad HC warns against misuse of criminal law in short-lived marriages, quashes dowry FIR (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- India's services demand outlook positive for Q3FY27, margin concerns persist: RBI (Economy) Economic Times
- Vettri Payanam Thittam: what is the economic mileage of a no-fare bus ride? (Governance & Policy) The Hindu

- IAF chief AP Singh to fly last sortie in Tejas fighter jet today (Defence) Hindustan Times
- India's UNHRC mandate reflects global trust, says EAM Jaishankar at 61st Session (International Relations) DD News
- Delhi SIR: ECI Forcing BLOs to Sign Off on Voters Without Verification (Polity & Constitution) The Reporters' Collective
- NTA reforms | Administrations should withhold permissions for rallies, processions on exam days: panel (Education) Hindustan Times
- Child marriage: Progress made, but millions of girls still at risk in India, say experts (Social Justice & Welfare) Hindustan Times
- Nuclear war, AI-enabled bioweapons could wipe out humanity by 2100: Lancet report (Science & Technology) Hindustan Times
- Anantha Nageswaran releases 'white paper' on AI, automation, and India's workforce (Economy) The Hindu
- MPEDA, Odisha Chart Seafood Export Roadmap to Realise Deep Sea Mission Targets (Agriculture & Allied) Pragativadi
- Supreme Court Upholds Appellant State in Service Law Reservation for Women. Special Provision Under Article 15(3) Constitution of India, 1950 Permits 30% Reservation for Women in Public Employment Within 50% Ceiling. (Polity & Constitution) Lawtext
- 11 Indians Injured in Riyadh Airport Attack; Indian Embassy Coordinates with Saudi Authorities (International Relations) Indian Express
- Villages evacuated as flash flood from Budhi Gandaki River hits northern Nepal (Disaster Management) The Hindu
- India's Deep-Tech Pivot: Why Russia And BRICS Are Central To The New Manufacturing Agenda (International Relations) Goodreturns
- Central Bureau of Narcotics (CBN) M.P. Unit seizes over 4.2 tonnes of poppy straw in two operations; Three persons arrested (Internal Security) PIB
- On the Independence of the Election Commission of India (Polity & Constitution) Countercurrents
- US President Trump urges Ukraine to elect new president to negotiate peace deal with Russia (International Relations) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- NGT Issues Notices to Odisha Chief Secretary, Forest Officials and Others Over Non-Compliance With Maninag Reserve Forest Encroachment Order (Environment & Ecology) Countercurrents
- Focus on actual payouts, not just claim settlement ratios: IRDAI Chairman (Economy) BusinessLine
- Income Tax Liability on Revived Debts: Supreme Court Clarifies Rules (Economy) The Law Observer
- Supreme Court Takes Note Of Fake Medical College In UP Operating From Farmhouse With Illiterate Tea... (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- Statement on remarks made by the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights (International Relations) Ministry of External Affairs
- Migratory birds return to Kashmir, but are wetlands ready? (Environment & Ecology) Kashmir Vision
- NHAI mandates 80% plantation and 90% survival rate for highway completion certification (Infrastructure & Energy) DD News
- India's BRICS Moment (International Relations) Eurasia Review
- BRICS Or Balance? What Ghana's bid really means (International Relations) MyJoyOnline
- Demographic strength gives BRICS countries an opportunity to shape the future of work: Mansukh Mandaviya (International Relations) DD News
- China, Pakistan armies to hold joint drills (Defence) ThePrint
- "Unacceptable": India On Missile Attack On Riyadh Airport That Killed 12 (International Relations) NDTV
- AGRBEMENT BETWEEN THE GOVERNMENT OF THE REPUBLIC OF INDIA AND THE GOVERNMENT OF THE REPUBLIC OF ARMENIA THB INTER-GOVERNMENTAL C (International Relations) Ministry of External Affairs
- India's water crisis is becoming an agriculture crisis: What can farmers do differently? (Agriculture & Allied) BusinessLine
- Learn from India before Malayan tiger falls silent (Environment & Ecology) NST Online
- NGT Seeks Himachal Tourism Carrying Capacity Details (Environment & Ecology) The Chenab Times
- A proposed nuclear plant runs into resistance even before takeoff in Madhya Pradesh (Infrastructure & Energy) Indian Express
- Navantia, Larsen & Toubro to Collaborate for India's LPD Race, Sign MoU (Defence) Raksha Anirveda
- Strengthening India's Space Sovereignty (Science & Technology) PIB

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 17 must-know, 23 Prelims facts, 51 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (13), International Relations (4), Agriculture & Allied (4), Governance & Policy (4), Economy (3), Environment & Ecology (3), Disaster Management (2), Science & Technology (1), Internal Security (1), Defence (1), Education (1), Health (1), Social Justice & Welfare (1), Infrastructure & Energy (1). **Nothing today in —** History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 2 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 3 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 1 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 2 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 1

Full text — 31 of 67 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 12, Hindustan Times 8, Economic Times 6, PIB 5, BusinessLine 5, Indian Express 5, The Law Observer 3, Firstpost 3, Mint 3, ddnews.gov.in 2, indianmasterminds.com 2, thestatesman.com 1, NewsBytes 1, AgroSpectrum India 1

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